

SmarterContact Part 1: Campaign Setup and SMS Templates

A Step By Step Guide

Lux Blueprint

This guide walks you through the first half of using SmarterContact. By the end, you will know how to take a list you pulled, get it into SmarterContact, write text templates that get replies, and launch your campaign. Part 2 covers what to do once people start replying, which ones to call, and how to work the leads.

Step 1: Export Your List As A CSV

Start with the list you pulled from Virtual Flip Leads. Go to your list and download it. It will download as an .xlsx file. SmarterContact needs a CSV, so we have to convert it.

Open the file in Excel, Google Sheets, or Numbers. It does not matter which one. We are only converting it. Go to File, then Export, and export it as a .csv file. Save it somewhere easy to find, like your desktop. That is all you have to do here.

Step 2: Upload Your Contacts Into SmarterContact

Log in to SmarterContact. Go to Contacts, then Upload Contacts, and pick the CSV you just saved. It only takes a second to upload.

Now map your fields. Match each column in your file to the right field in SmarterContact. For example:

- Heading 1 is first name.
- Heading 2 is last name.
- Then property city, property state, and property address.
- Mark every one of the five phone number columns as phone.

Tip: if you always export the same fields from Virtual Flip Leads, you can save this mapping as a template. Name it Virtual Flip Leads and you will never have to map fields again. It only takes a minute either way.

Why Five Phone Numbers?

When we skip trace a list, we get five numbers back for each property. Here is why. Skip tracing companies use a bunch of data brokers to guess who owns a property and what their number is. Sometimes they get the right person. Sometimes they get their son or their grandma. The numbers are ranked, so phone one is the most likely to be the owner. But phone five could still be their cell phone.

We text every single number. Yes, that means some people will say wrong number. That is normal. Texting all five gives us the best chance of reaching the person we want.

There is a bonus too. Sometimes those other numbers are family members tied to the property. We have gotten deals from people who said, hey, that is my parents' house, they have been wanting to sell, let me connect you. The more people you reach who are tied to that property, the better your odds of locking it up.

Step 3: Verify Your Contacts

Click Verify Contacts. On the next screen, the opted out column is always set to opt out. Leave it that way. The other settings on this screen are personal decisions you have to make yourself. We are not attorneys and this is not legal advice.

SmarterContact will run through your list and sort the numbers into valid mobile, landline, and invalid.

For example, our list of about 1,500 records came back with about 3,000 valid mobile numbers. Press next and your contacts are ready.

Step 4: Start Your Campaign

Go to Campaigns and create a new standard campaign. Name it after the zip code and the month, like 85260 July. That way you always know what it was and when you sent it. Add the list you just uploaded and set the campaign type to text.

Now comes the important part: your message templates. You always want eight or more templates in a campaign. More is better.

Step 5: Learn The Three Types Of Templates

There are three types of messages we send, and every campaign should have a mix of all three. Different people respond to different messages, so we want all three types working for us. Three of each type is a good starting mix.

The first two template types follows the same simple structure:

- Intro: who are you?
- Body: pitch your value. Why should they care?
- CTA: what is the next step?

Type 1: Value Proposition Templates

These show the person the value of working with us in the very first message. Think about the features and benefits. Why would someone sell to us instead of listing with a realtor? There are no realtor fees. We pay the closing costs. They pick their close date. There are no inspections. There are no disclosures. There are no repairs. They can even stay in the property for a while after close. Each value proposition template should highlight one or two of these.

Type 2: Offer Templates

These make the person a real offer in the very first text. We give them a price range right away, like somewhere between \$1.5 and \$2 million. This shows them we are serious and we are here to do business, and it gets the price shoppers to reply.

Give a range, and say the price depends on lot size and orientation. Here is why. Our list has lots from three quarters of an acre up to a full acre, and the price is different for each. A range also builds curiosity. Someone thinks, I would like to know what my exact property is worth, and they reply. Even if their lot is on the low end of the range, now you have them on the phone and you can nurture and negotiate. Also write NET in capital letters so they know that number is what goes in their pocket.

Type 3: Follow Up Templates

These have one mission only: get a reply. This is a cold text that sounds like a follow up, like hey, did you get my offer? The person texts back, what offer? Now the door is open. You reply with the same pitch as always: we work with a small group of developers in Scottsdale, your property came up as a fit for our next project, are you interested in selling?

Here is why this works so well. SmarterContact only charges credits for the first message out. Once somebody replies, you can text them back and forth for free. These messages also get very high response rates. And since they are short, they only cost one credit to send. That is a big deal if you are starting out with a smaller credit plan.

Step 6: Copy Our Example Templates

Here are the exact templates we built on the call. You will see typos in a couple of them. Those are on purpose. Keep reading and we will explain why in the writing rules.

Value Proposition Examples

Hello this is Tyson, I work with a small group of developers in Scottsdale and we are looking for our next project. Your property on <Address> came up as a potential fit. We are flexible with our closing timelines and can even allow you to stay in the property for a bit after the sale. Worth a chat?

Hello, Sarah here. My company is looking for its next project in Scottsdale, and your property at <Address> came up as a potential fit. Our process is simple, we pay market value and we cover all closing costs + there are no realtor fees. Interested in learning more?

Hi, my name is Ashley and im reaching out about your place on <Address>. I work with a small gorup of developers in Scottsdale/PV and your place came up as a fit. Interested in an as is sale? No inspections, disclosures, or repairs necessary. Let me know.

Offer Examples

Hello this is Tyson, I work with a small group of developers in Scottsdale and we are looking for our next project. Your property on <Address> came up as a potential fit. Not here to waste your time, we'd be somewhere between \$1.5 and \$2M. Interested in learning more?

Hello this is Isabella. I am reaching out in regards to your property on <Address>. Not here to waste your time, so I will cut to the chase. We would be around \$1.5M to \$1.9M NET to you, depending on specific lot size and orientation. Any interest in chatting?

Hello this is Mary. We are looking to find our next project and your property on <Address> came up as a fit. We are paying market value (\$1.5M to \$2M) depending on specific lot size. We are local and family owned so terms are flexible, any interest?

Follow Up Examples

Hey its Tyson did you get my offer?

Hey any thoughts on what I sent you?

Hey did you have a chance to look that over? No rush

Notice how each message appeals to a different kind of person. Cut to the chase appeals to the type A business guy. Local and family owned with flexible terms appeals to the 70 year old grandma. Flexible closing timelines appeals to the person who needs to wait for the school year to end. No inspections or disclosures appeals to the person who is scared of getting sued over something they forgot to disclose. Rich people are very litigious, and sellers know it. Every template should scratch a different itch.

This matters because we send to the same list every single month. Someone might ignore the flexible timeline message this month, then reply the moment they see a price next month. Different messages catch different people.

Step 7: Follow The Writing Rules

Watch Out For Banned Words

Phone carriers like Verizon, AT&T, and T-Mobile filter cold texts. If a cold text from an unknown number contains certain words, the carrier will never deliver it. You still pay the credit, but the person never sees it. SmarterContact will block certain phrases when you build a template, like cash offer. If it blocks a word, swap it for a safer one. For example, use did you get my message instead of did you get my offer.

Skip Their First Name

In a perfect world we would use a custom field to drop in their first name, and you would get more responses. But in luxury markets, a lot of properties are owned by LLCs and trusts instead of people. That means many records have no real first name. So we leave names out of the message entirely.

Use A Simple, Common Name For Yourself

You do not have to use your real name. A common woman's name like Sarah, Emily, Jenna, or Megan typically gets better responses. Stay away from names like Chad or Brody. If you have a pretty regular name and you plan on calling these leads yourself, just use your own, like Tyson does.

What if you texted as Sarah and they ask on the phone, who is Ashley? Easy. That is my assistant. My assistant sent you a text about your property. Then go right into your script.

Change Up Your Wording

All your templates say roughly the same thing, but the sentence structure and word order should be moved around in every one. This is intentional. When you send a thousand messages, changing up the wording protects your phone numbers from getting flagged as spam by the carriers. Your numbers last longer and you get more responses.

Typos Are Your Friend

Leave a typo or two on purpose. In a world where everyone uses AI to write everything, a typo tells the reader a real human typed this. Little things like that build trust in 2026. That is why our templates say “im” and “gorup”. We left those in on purpose.

Long Messages Cost More

A long message costs two or more credits to send. We think it is worth it to fully explain the value, so we send them. If you are tight on credits, shorten your messages or lean on follow up templates, which only cost one credit.

Test Your CTAs

Worth a chat works great in some markets. In other markets, like the Northeast, it might rub people the wrong way. Test different CTAs, check the reporting, and keep what works in your market.

Step 8: Add Your Templates To The Campaign

Inside the campaign, create each template and name them something simple like Lux 1, Lux 2, Lux 3. When you type the message, use the Address custom field so SmarterContact drops in each property address automatically. Make sure there are no extra spaces around it. Save each one.

Then select your templates for the campaign. Remember, at least eight. More is better. There is no limit, so you could run 15 if you want.

Step 9: Buy Local Phone Numbers

Always text from a phone number local to the market. Never text an Arizona list from a Florida number. Your response rate will fall off a cliff.

Buying numbers in SmarterContact is easy. Search by area code, pick your numbers, and pay about \$2 per month each. For the size of lists we pull, about three numbers is all you need. Your A2P registration from your initial setup covers every new number you add, and new numbers are live in your account in about five minutes.

Step 10: Set Up Sending And The Auto Follow Up

You can schedule the campaign to send later, like first thing in the morning, or you can send everything at once. We just send all at once.

Under actions for replies, always set this up: when a contact replies by text or call, add the label Answered. Do this on every campaign. It makes working your leads way easier later.

Then set up at least one automatic follow up message: wait one day, then send a simple text. Since your templates use different names, do not use a name in the follow up. Just say something like: Hey, it's me again. Checking in. Any interest?

One warning here. Do not say you were driving the area unless you actually drive that area. If you are texting Miami from Arizona, that little white lie can cost you trust on the phone later. Keep it simple and honest.

You can add more follow up steps after seven days if you want, but we typically just do the one. We handle the rest by resending the same campaign to the same list every month with different templates.

Step 11: Send At The Right Time

States have different rules on this, and we are not attorneys, so this is not legal advice. Our rule: never text before 9 am or after 8 pm in the seller's local time zone.

Weekends and holidays can be great. A lot of people are relaxed and on their phones on Sunday afternoons. Some of our students see their best response rates on Saturdays, especially with retired owners.

Step 12: Review And Improve Every Month

You only have to build your templates once. Then every month, open the reporting in SmarterContact and look at which templates got the most responses. Keep the winners. Rewrite the losers. It can be as small as changing a few words or swapping the CTA.

Write your own templates instead of only copying ours. This is a skill that can make you a lot of money, and the only way to build it is to write, test, and read your reporting. You will get better every single month.

A Quick Note On Plans

Only use the monthly Elite plans on SmarterContact. Never buy the quarterly plans. They come with zero credits, they charge you about three cents per message, and they do not let you remove the opt out language from your texts. They end up costing more than the Elite plans.

The plan we recommend students start with is the Elite Plus 20K at \$799 per month. It comes with 20,000 credits per month, which is more than enough to do multiple deals a month. Use code TYSON when you sign up for any Elite plan and you get \$200 off your first month.